



REPORTED SPEECH



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
1HI6-S1L2-7C3



1

Presentation

There are two ways of telling somebody what another person said *direct speech* and *reported speech*.

Direct speech	Reported speech
repeats the exact words that somebody said:	reports what somebody said without repeating the exact words:
Peter said, "I'm at home."	Peter said that he was at home.
The politician said, "I will create many new jobs."	The politician said that he would create many new jobs.
Alison said, "I went out on Saturday."	Alison said that she went out on Saturday. / Alison said that she had gone out on Saturday.
Omar said, "I've never been to China."	Omar said that he had never been to China.
Daniel said, "I can't speak French."	Daniel said that he couldn't speak French.
Pavel said, "I want to go to the concert."	Pavel said that he wanted to go to the concert.

Rules for forming reported speech



1. The tense of the verb in *direct speech* changes in *reported speech*.

am/is → **was**

are → **were**

present simple

→ **past simple**

will → **would**

can → **could**

2. The past simple in *direct speech* (went) can stay the same in *reported speech*, or we can use the *past perfect* (had gone).

Jackie said that she **went** to the store.

Jackie said that she **had gone** to the store.

3. We can leave out the word *that*.

A) Peter said **that** he was at home.

B) Peter said he was at home.

4. If the situation has not changed, it is not necessary to change the tense.

Peter said that he **was** at home. (*Maybe he is still at home now. Maybe he isn't.*)

Peter said he **is** at home. (*He is still at home now.*)

5. But if the situation has changed, we usually change the tense. We may also need to change the time expression:

John said, "I'm feeling bad **today**." → John said he **was** feeling bad **that day**.

Paulina said, "I'm coming **tomorrow**." → Paulina said she **was** coming **the next day**.



2

Practice

Daniella meets Martin for the second time. She finds out that he isn't being completely honest. Look at what he told her the week before and complete their conversation below. Change the tense.

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| A) "I can speak French fluently." | B) "I have a Mercedes." |
| C) "I'm going to Miami this summer." | D) "I won't forget your name." |
| E) "I don't drink alcohol." | F) "I live alone." |
| G) "I've travelled all over the world." | H) "I have my own business." |

Dialogue 1

- a. **Martin:** My boss gave me a promotion today!
- b. **Daniella:** But I thought you said _____¹.

Dialogue 2

- a. **Martin:** I've never been to China.
- b. **Daniella:** But I thought you told me _____¹.

Dialogue 3

- a. **Martin:** I take the train to work every day.
- b. **Daniella:** But didn't you say _____^{1?}

Dialogue 4

- a. **Martin:** Let's go for a beer tomorrow evening.
- b. **Daniella:** But you said _____¹.

Dialogue 5

- a. **Martin:** I was at a French restaurant. The food was great, but the waiters refused to speak English!
- b. **Daniella:** But I thought you said _____¹.



Dialogue 6

- a. **Martin:** Sorry, I have to answer the phone. It's my flatmate.
b. **Daniella:** But you told me _____¹.

Dialogue 7

- a. **Martin:** I'm going to stay at home this summer, so we can meet all the time.
b. **Daniella:** But didn't you say _____¹?

Dialogue 8

- a. **Martin:** It was nice to see you again, Maria.
b. **Daniella:** It's Daniella. I thought you said _____¹.

Now complete the reported statements below. Change the tense from direct speech **ONLY** where necessary.

Direct speech	Reported speech
Joe said, "I'm going away this week."	Joe said he (1) _____ that week.
The athlete said, "I will win the race tomorrow."	The athlete said he (2) _____ tomorrow.
The news reporter said, "People have been protesting in the streets today."	The news reporter said people (3) _____ that day.
The director said, "The company will continue to grow next year."	The director said the company (4) _____ next year.
Last year, the doctor said, "You need to rest more."	Last year, the doctor told me I (5) _____.
The president said, "I won't lose the election."	The president said he (6) _____, but he did.



Key

1. Presentation

10 mins.

Have students go through examples of direct speech and reported speech in the first box. You may want to have students take turns reading each pair of sentences aloud for the class.

Students should read through the 5 rule boxes. Elicit from the class the rule for each box to check comprehension. For example, 'What happens to the verb in reported speech?', 'What two tenses can you use when reporting a past simple sentence?', etc. Elicit further examples of time references that change for rule 5: yesterday=the day before; last night=the night before/the previous night.

For additional support, have students cover the reported speech column and take turns quizzing a partner on the correct reported speech statement for each direct speech statement.

2. Practice

10-15 mins.

For the dialogues, have students read through the box of statements from the earlier conversation. If students need extra support, have them underline the verbs in the sentences to draw attention to what needs to change. Students can work alone or in partners to complete the 8 dialogues but should check answers with a partner before checking as a whole class. Early finishers can role play the dialogues with a partner to help internalise the grammar.

For transforming the statements, do the first one together as an example, eliciting whether or not the situation is changed or unchanged and drawing attention to the time reference 'that day' as evidence of a changed situation. Students work together with a partner to complete the rest of the statements. While checking be sure to have students justify how they know if a situation is changed or unchanged.

Dialogues:

1. you had your own business
2. you had travelled all over the world
3. you had a Mercedes
4. you didn't drink alcohol (another possible answer is "you don't drink alcohol" if we consider the statement as telling the truth - then the situation is unchanged)
5. you could speak French fluently
6. you lived alone
7. you were going to Miami this summer
8. you wouldn't forget my name

Statements:

1. was going away; 2. will win the race
3. had been protesting in the streets; 4. will continue to grow



5. needed to rest more; 6. wouldn't lose the election